

The British Sector of the Western Front, 1914–1918

The Historic Environment · Injuries, Treatment and the Trenches · Complete Mastery & Source Studio

Pupil Name: _____

Class / Set: _____

Target Grade: []

SECTION A PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER (16 MARKS TOTAL)

Marked by Teacher or Peer Verified

Assessment Component & Stem Focus	Format Style	Max Marks	Pupil Score
Round 1 (Stepped): Q1(a) Feature 1 (Casualty Clearing Stations)	Stepped Ladder	/2	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q1(b) Feature 2 (Thomas Splint)	Stepped Ladder	/2	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q2(b) 4-Part Follow-Up Grid (Base Hospital Water)	Stepped Ladder	/4	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q2(a) Source Utility (Somme CCS vs Base Hospital)	Stepped Ladder	/8	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q1(a) & Q1(b) Features (Mobile X-rays & Trench Fever)	Dual Track	/4	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q2(b) 4-Part Follow-Up Grid (Gas Casualties)	Dual Track	/4	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q2(a) Source Utility (RAMC Logbook & Flanders Mud)	Dual Track	/8	_____
Round 3 (Simulation): Full Section A Timed Exam Pitch (Q1a, Q1b, Q2a, Q2b)	Exam Hall (25m)	/16	_____
TOTAL COMBINED EXAM PRACTICE MARKS:		/48	_____ / 48

Teacher / Peer Marker: _____

Date: _____

Overall Grade: [9 8 7 6 5 4]

SECTION A EDEXCEL EXAM FAST FACTS & STEM BLUEPRINTS (16 MARKS · ~25 MINS) OPTION 11 PAPER 1 SECTION A

- Q1(a) & Q1(b) Features (2 Marks each · ~3 mins each): *F-D Formula*. State **Feature** in sentence 1 → support with 1 precise supporting factual detail. (2 separate questions).
- Q2(a) Source Utility (8 Marks · ~12 mins): *C-O-P Matrix*. Evaluate both sources for **Content** (what it says) → **Own Contextual Knowledge** → **Provenance** (Nature, Origin, Purpose / NOP).
- Q2(b) Follow-Up Investigation (4 Marks · ~7 mins): *4-Step Enquiry*. Quote **Detail in Source B** → Formulate **Targeted Question** → Name **Specific Historical Source Type** → Explain **Direct Purpose**.

SECTION A: THE HISTORIC ENVIRONMENT

Round 1: The Stepped Ladder · Question 1 (Features) & Question 2(b) (Follow-Up Investigation)

ROUND 1: STEMS 1 & 2B

Question 1 (a): Feature Question (2 Marks)

F-D Formula · ~3 Mins

Describe one feature of the work of Casualty Clearing Stations (CCS) on the Western Front.

 **Level 1 Launchpad:** Starter: "One feature of Casualty Clearing Stations was that..."
Facts to Include: Located 7–12 miles back near railways; triage (walking wounded, urgent surgery, dying); performed critical amputations and chest surgeries before base evacuation.

One feature of Casualty Clearing Stations was that...

Specifically, (add one precise historical detail or statistic)...

Question 1 (b): Feature Question (2 Marks)

F-D Formula · ~3 Mins

Describe one feature of the use of the Thomas splint on the Western Front.

 **Level 1 Launchpad:** Starter: "One feature of the Thomas splint was that..."
Facts to Include: Introduced in 1915 by Robert Jones; rigid frame pulled leg straight to stop bone ends grinding; dramatically dropped compound fracture mortality from 80% to 20%.

One feature of the Thomas splint was that...

Specifically, (add one precise historical detail or statistic)...

Question 2 (b): Follow-Up Investigation Grid (4 Marks)

4-Step Enquiry · ~6 Mins

Study Source B (Edith Smith letter: "The pipes freeze entirely, meaning we must strictly ration the water provided to the wounded."). How could you follow up Source B to find out more about the severe conditions faced by medical staff? Complete the table below.

Detail in Source B that I would follow up:	"The pipes freeze entirely, meaning we must strictly ration the water provided to the wounded."
Question I would ask:	What specific impact did water shortages have on surgical sterilization and infection rates in winter 1917?
What type of source I would use:	Base Hospital Daily Medical Superintendent Logbooks and Sanitary Inspection Reports (1917–18).
How this source would help me answer my question:	It would provide official daily records of sanitation breakdowns and hospital infection rates during freezing months.

Question 2 (a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

C-O-P Formula · ~12 Mins

Study Sources A and B. How useful are Sources A and B for an historian studying the immense challenges of treating casualties on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context.

Source A (Chaplain Arthur Davies, Somme CCS, July 1916):

"The casualties have started to arrive... The volume of patients is overwhelming; every bed is occupied, and men are fortunate just to find a spot on the bare ground. Many will pass away before surgery is possible. We have admitted 1,500 casualties, and the stream has not stopped."

Source B (Edith Smith, VAD Nurse, Base Hospital, Dec 1917):

"Our morning duties begin at 3.30 am! The freezing temperatures are unbearable. Icicles hang thick over ward windows. Even kettles, rubber hot water bottles, and sponges have frozen solid. The pipes freeze entirely, meaning we must strictly ration water provided to the wounded."

PROVENANCE CLUES (Author, Audience, Motive): Who wrote each source (eyewitness chaplain at CCS vs frontline VAD nurse at base hospital)? What was their motive (private diary recording sheer volume vs private letter home detailing physical conditions)? How does their perspective make the sources useful despite subjective emotional focus?

PARAGRAPH 1: UTILITY OF SOURCE A (CONTENT + PROVENANCE + CONTEXT)

Source A is useful for investigating casualty challenges because the content reveals...

From my own knowledge, this accurately reflects the Somme offensive because...

Furthermore, the provenance makes it useful because as a private chaplain's diary...

PARAGRAPH 2: UTILITY OF SOURCE B & COMPARATIVE JUDGEMENT (CONTENT + PROVENANCE + CONTEXT)

Source B is also useful because it highlights the severe environmental difficulties...

Specifically, my own knowledge confirms that Base Hospitals in winter 1917...

The provenance enhances its utility because as a private letter from a VAD nurse...

Overall, both sources are mutually useful because together they demonstrate...

Level 3 (Grade 9) Utility Glue: Weigh up typicality vs limitation — note that Source A shows peak crisis conditions on 1 July 1916 (57,000 casualties in one day), while Source B reflects seasonal winter extremes at the coast.

Questions 1(a) & 1(b): Features (2 + 2 = 4 Marks)

Independent Toolkit

 Fact Vault (AO1)

- **Mobile X-rays:** 6 mobile units in British sector; located at CCS; couldn't detect clothing fragments; tubes overheated.
- **Trench Fever:** Caused by body lice; flu-like pain in legs; affected ~15% of men; led to delousing stations and bathhouses.

 **Trap:** Do not confuse Trench Fever (lice) with Trench Foot (underground mudholes).

Question 2(b): Follow-Up Practice (4 Marks)

Historical Records Directory

Study this extract from an RAMC officer at Ypres: "The chlorine gas casualties stumbled in clutching their throats. We washed their blinded eyes with bicarbonate of soda solutions, but many died from asphyxiation."

Detail in Source to follow up:	"We washed their blinded eyes with bicarbonate of soda solutions..."
Question I would ask:	How effective were early chemical antidotes compared to later respirator gas masks?
What type of source I would use:	RAMC Field Ambulance Casualty Admission Books & War Office Gas Defence Bulletins (1915).
How this source would help me:	It would record official medical survival rates of gas victims before and after the issue of Small Box Respirators.

Question 2(a): Source Utility Independent Execution (8 Marks) Wartime Trauma & Gas Warfare

How useful are Source C (RAMC Logbook, 1915) and Source D (Official Training Manual on Trench Foot, 1916) for an enquiry into the prevention of trench illness on the Western Front?

 Provenance Evaluation Matrix

Official Reports: High factual accuracy regarding procedures; may minimize failure to maintain morale.

Doctor/Nurse Accounts: Direct clinical insight into actual suffering; localized to one specific sector.

 Causal & Utility Connectives

- "The content is highly useful because it reveals..."
- "The provenance strengthens its value because..."
- "However, the source is limited in scope because..."

 **Level 3 Standard:** Explicitly evaluate how the author's professional role and purpose shape what was included or omitted.

PARAGRAPH 1: UTILITY OF SOURCE C

Source C is useful for an enquiry into prevention because...

Its provenance as an RAMC logbook means...

PARAGRAPH 2: UTILITY OF SOURCE D & SYNTHESIS

Source D is useful in a different way because it shows official policy on...

However, an official manual may not reflect actual frontline reality because...

Comparing both sources, an historian learns that...

SECTION A: THE HISTORIC ENVIRONMENT

Round 3: Timed Exam Simulation · Stems 1(a), 1(b) Features & 2(b) Follow-Up (8 Marks · 12 Mins)

TIMED PITCH PART 1

⚡ PRE-FLIGHT PLANNING ENGINE · FEATURES & FOLLOW-UP (8 MARKS · ~12 MINS)

1. Q1 Features (4m · ~6 mins):
F-D Formula: 1 feature + 1 specific fact. (e.g. Arras: 700 beds/electricity; Cambrai: Robertson blood bank).

2. Q2(b) Follow-Up (4m · ~6 mins):
Quote exact detail → Targeted enquiry question → Primary archival record (RAMC War Diaries) → Direct purpose.

OPTION 11 BLUEPRINT

Question 1(a) (2 Marks): Describe one feature of the underground hospital at Arras:

One feature of the underground hospital at Arras was...

Question 1(b) (2 Marks): Describe one feature of blood transfusion techniques on the Western Front:

One feature of blood transfusion techniques was...

Question 2(b) (4 Marks): Study Source B (Edith Smith letter on frozen pipes). How could you follow up Source B to find out more about the severe conditions faced by medical staff?

Detail in Source B to follow up:	<u>"The pipes freeze entirely, meaning we must strictly ration the water provided to the wounded."</u>
Question I would ask:	
What type of source I would use:	
How this source would help me:	

Question 2(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

C-O-P Matrix · ~13 Mins

Study Sources A and B. How useful are Sources A and B for an enquiry into the immense difficulties of casualty evacuation on the Western Front? Explain your answer, using Sources A and B and your knowledge of the historical context.

Source A (RAMC Stretcher Bearer, Ypres Salient, Oct 1917):

"The mud was waist-deep in places. Duckboards were blown to splinters by artillery fire. It took four of us six agonizing hours to carry a single stretcher back from the front line to the Advanced Dressing Station, slipping constantly into shell craters."

Source B (Official War Office Medical Evacuation Report, 1917):

"The evacuation chain relies upon motor ambulance convoys from Dressing Stations to railheads. However, in heavy bombardments, roads become impassable. Canal barges along the Yser and railway ambulance carriages equipped with heating stoves must be prioritized."

PROVENANCE CLUES (Author, Audience, Motive): Contrast a frontline stretcher bearer's immediate visceral journal (recording physical exhaustion) with an official military report (recording logistical systems and infrastructure).

PARAGRAPH 1: UTILITY OF SOURCE A (CONTENT + CONTEXT + PROVENANCE)

Source A is useful for investigating casualty evacuation because the content reveals...

From my own knowledge of the Western Front, this reflects the conditions of...

Furthermore, the provenance makes it useful because as a frontline stretcher bearer...

PARAGRAPH 2: UTILITY OF SOURCE B & COMPARATIVE JUDGEMENT

Source B is also useful because it highlights the wider logistical challenges of...

Specifically, my own knowledge confirms that motor ambulances and canal barges...

The provenance enhances its utility because as an official War Office report...

Overall, comparing both sources, an historian learns that while Source A reveals...

...Source B provides the broader strategic perspective on the evacuation chain.

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR SECTION A

• The "Generic Source" Trap

Never write "I would check a diary" or "the internet" in Q2(b). You must specify an authentic record type, like RAMC War Diaries or Hospital Admission Registers.

• The "Treachery of Bias" Trap

Never reject a source simply because "it is biased so it's useless". Sources written with strong emotion or wartime censorship are highly useful for showing attitudes!

• The Single Feature Trap

Remember Q1 is split into two questions: 1(a) and 1(b). Do not combine them into one paragraph. Each requires one identified feature + one specific factual detail.

SPECIFICATION PRACTICE BANK: 100% CURRICULUM COVERAGE

Every remaining Western Front specification bullet point tested below

- 1. Features (2m):** Describe one feature of the role of the FANY (First Aid Nursing Yeomanry) in ambulance transport.
- 2. Features (2m):** Describe one feature of the effects of mustard gas on soldiers.
- 3. Source Utility (8m):** How useful are official trench casualty statistics compared to private letters for studying the effectiveness of Brodie helmets?
- 4. Features (2m):** Describe one feature of the Carrel-Dakin method for treating gas gangrene.
- 5. Follow-Up (4m):** Detail: "*Ambulance barges along the Somme-Yser canal were fitted with spring beds.*" Formulate a question and name a primary source.

⚡ **QUICK-FIRE FOLLOW-UP SOURCE DRILL:** When asked to research: (1) *Wound infections* → RAMC Medical Officer Daily Logs; (2) *Frontline delousing routines* → Battalion War Diaries; (3) *Blood transfusions* → CCS Surgical Register.